

Kestrel Logistics - Annual Operations Review 2026

Section 1. Network summary

The European network handled 4.18 million shipments during the reporting year, an increase of eleven percent over the previous year. Hamburg remained the largest hub with 1.32 million shipments, followed by Rotterdam with 0.91 million and Lyon with 0.64 million.

Section 2. Forecast accuracy

The demand-forecasting platform supplied by Northwind Analytics reached a weighted mean absolute percentage error of 8.4 percent across all warehouses, against a target of 10 percent. Accuracy was weakest in the Lyon region during the second quarter.

Section 3. Cold chain incident

On 14 August 2026 the refrigeration unit at the Rotterdam cross-dock failed during a heat warning. The root cause of the cold chain failure was a blocked condenser coil that had been flagged in the June inspection but was not scheduled for cleaning, because the maintenance backlog was ranked by

asset age rather than by inspection severity. Total spoilage was recorded at EUR 312,000 and the insurer settled 78 percent of the claim.

Section 4. Corrective actions

The maintenance backlog is now ranked by inspection severity first and asset age second. A second condenser was installed at Rotterdam in October 2026 to remove the single point of failure.

Section 5. Headcount

Planning headcount grew from 41 to 47 full-time equivalents. Two roles remain open in the Lyon planning team as of 31 December 2026.

Section 6. Outlook

Volume growth of six to eight percent is expected for 2027, concentrated in the Iberian corridor. No additional hub investment is planned before the second half of the year.